ENVIRONMENTAL IMPACT ASSESSMENT AND NGT

PRIOR-CLEARANCE FIREWALL → APPROVAL MATRIX → CLASSIFICATION GATE → FOUR-PROCESS DISTINCTION → EIA EVIDENCE CHAIN → CONSULTATION QUALITY GATE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◇ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

PRIOR-CLEARANCE FIREWALL

PRIOR-CLEARANCE FIREWALL · PROJECT CONCEPT · TEST EIA SCHEDULE APPLICABILITY · PRIOR EC REQUIRED · APPRAISAL BEFORE PROHIBITED START · CONDITIONAL GRANT OR REJECTION · COMPETENT AUTHORITY DECISION · CONSTRUCTION OR OPERATION

PROJECT CONCEPT → test EIA schedule applicability → PRIOR EC REQUIRED → appraisal before prohibited start → CONDITIONAL GRANT OR REJECTION → competent authority decision → CONSTRUCTION OR OPERATION → only under applicable approvals → RULE → later paperwork cannot recreate prior appraisal

CORE CLAIM
- PROJECT CONCEPT → test EIA schedule applicability
- PRIOR EC REQUIRED → appraisal before prohibited start

MECHANISM
- CONDITIONAL GRANT OR REJECTION → competent authority decision
- CONSTRUCTION OR OPERATION → only under applicable approvals

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- RULE → later paperwork cannot recreate prior appraisal
- MUST REMEMBER: EIA is a prior decision-support and clearance process with screening,...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → later paperwork cannot recreate prior appraisal.

01

STAGE 01

APPROVAL MATRIX

APPROVAL MATRIX · ENVIRONMENTAL CLEARANCE · PROJECT IMPACT APPRAISAL · CTE OR CTO · POLLUTION-CONTROL CONSENT · FOREST CLEARANCE · FOREST-LAW DECISION · WILDLIFE OR CRZ APPROVAL

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
ENVIRONMENTAL CLEARANCE → project impact appraisal	FOREST CLEARANCE → forest-law decision	NO SUBSTITUTION → each approval retains its own test
CTE OR CTO → pollution-control consent	WILDLIFE OR CRZ APPROVAL → separate legal interest	ENVIRONMENTAL CLEARANCE → project impact appraisal

CORE CLAIM
- ENVIRONMENTAL CLEARANCE → project impact appraisal
- CTE OR CTO → pollution-control consent

MECHANISM
- FOREST CLEARANCE → forest-law decision
- WILDLIFE OR CRZ APPROVAL → separate legal interest

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- NO SUBSTITUTION → each approval retains its own test
- ENVIRONMENTAL CLEARANCE → project impact appraisal

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NO SUBSTITUTION → each approval retains its own test.

02

STAGE 02

CLASSIFICATION GATE

CLASSIFICATION GATE · PROJECT OR ACTIVITY · READ CURRENT SCHEDULE · THRESHOLD AND LOCATION · APPLY NOTIFIED CRITERIA · CATEGORY A OR B · COMPETENT APPRAISAL LEVEL · B1 OR B2

PROJECT OR ACTIVITY → read current schedule

THRESHOLD AND LOCATION → apply notified criteria → CATEGORY A OR B → competent appraisal level → B1 OR B2 → assessment route only where supported

CORE CLAIM
- PROJECT OR ACTIVITY → read current schedule
- THRESHOLD AND LOCATION → apply notified criteria

MECHANISM
- CATEGORY A OR B → competent appraisal level
- B1 OR B2 → assessment route only where supported

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- NO GUESS → title or size alone is insufficient
- PROJECT OR ACTIVITY → read current schedule

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NO GUESS → title or size alone is insufficient.

03

STAGE 03

FOUR-PROCESS DISTINCTION

FOUR-PROCESS DISTINCTION · DETERMINE APPLICABLE ROUTE WHERE REQUIRED · SET SIGNIFICANT ISSUES AND TERMS OF REFERENCE · PUBLIC CONSULTATION · RECEIVE AFFECTED AND STAKEHOLDER CONCERNS · EXPERT REVIEW OF THE FULL RECORD · COMPETENT AUTHORITY GRANTS, CONDITIONS OR REJECTS

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
SCREENING → determine applicable route where required	PUBLIC CONSULTATION → receive affected and stakeholder concerns	DECISION → competent authority grants, conditions or rejects
SCOPING → set significant issues and terms of reference	APPRAISAL → expert review of the full record	SCREENING → determine applicable route where required

CORE CLAIM
- SCREENING → determine applicable route where required
- SCOPING → set significant issues and terms of reference

MECHANISM
- PUBLIC CONSULTATION → receive affected and stakeholder concerns
- APPRAISAL → expert review of the full record

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- DECISION → competent authority grants, conditions or rejects
- SCREENING → determine applicable route where required

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DECISION → competent authority grants, conditions or rejects.

04

STAGE 04

EIA EVIDENCE CHAIN

EIA EVIDENCE CHAIN · EXISTING ENVIRONMENTAL AND SOCIAL CONDITION · SITE, TECHNOLOGY AND NO-PROJECT COMPARISON · IMPACT PREDICTION · MAGNITUDE, DURATION AND UNCERTAINTY · AVOID, MINIMISE, RESTORE OR COMPENSATE · EMP AND MONITORING · IMPLEMENTATION AND VERIFICATION

BASELINE → existing environmental and social condition → ALTERNATIVES → site, technology and no-project comparison → IMPACT PREDICTION → magnitude, duration and uncertainty → MITIGATION → avoid, minimise, restore or compensate → EMP AND MONITORING → implementation and verification

CORE CLAIM
- BASELINE → existing environmental and social condition
- ALTERNATIVES → site, technology and no-project comparison

MECHANISM
- IMPACT PREDICTION → magnitude, duration and uncertainty
- MITIGATION → avoid, minimise, restore or compensate

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- EMP AND MONITORING → implementation and verification
- BASELINE → existing environmental and social condition

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MITIGATION → avoid, minimise, restore or compensate; EMP AND MONITORING → implementation and verification.

05

STAGE 05

CONSULTATION QUALITY GATE

CONSULTATION QUALITY GATE · READ CURRENT NOTIFICATION · NOTICE AND ACCESS · AFFECTED PEOPLE CAN INSPECT MATERIAL · HEARING OR WRITTEN RESPONSE · COLLECT CONCERNS · APPRAISAL RESPONSE · SHOW HOW ISSUES WERE CONSIDERED

APPLICABILITY → read current notification → NOTICE AND ACCESS → affected people can inspect material → HEARING OR WRITTEN RESPONSE → collect concerns → APPRAISAL RESPONSE → show how issues were considered → EXEMPTION CLAIM → cite exact provision or do not assert it

CORE CLAIM
- APPLICABILITY → read current notification
- NOTICE AND ACCESS → affected people can inspect material

MECHANISM
- HEARING OR WRITTEN RESPONSE → collect concerns
- APPRAISAL RESPONSE → show how issues were considered

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- EXEMPTION CLAIM → cite exact provision or do not assert it
- APPLICABILITY → read current notification

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EXEMPTION CLAIM → cite exact provision or do not assert it.

06

STAGE 06

RECOMMENDATION-DECISION LADDER

RECOMMENDATION-DECISION LADDER · PROJECT RECORD · EIA, EMP AND CONSULTATION MATERIAL · EXPERT COMMITTEE · APPRAISAL AND RECOMMENDATION · COMPETENT AUTHORITY · FINAL REASONED ORDER · ENFORCEABLE PROJECT OBLIGATIONS

PROJECT RECORD → EIA, EMP and consultation material

EXPERT COMMITTEE → appraisal and recommendation → COMPETENT AUTHORITY → final reasoned order → CONDITIONS → enforceable project obligations

CORE CLAIM
- PROJECT RECORD → EIA, EMP and consultation material
- EXPERT COMMITTEE → appraisal and recommendation

MECHANISM
- COMPETENT AUTHORITY → final reasoned order
- CONDITIONS → enforceable project obligations

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MONITORING → evidence after grant
- PROJECT RECORD → EIA, EMP and consultation material

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PROJECT RECORD → EIA, EMP and consultation material.

07

STAGE 07

GRANT-TO-OUTCOME CHAIN

GRANT-TO-OUTCOME CHAIN · CLEARANCE GRANTED · LEGAL DECISION · CONDITION LISTED · REQUIRED SAFEGUARD · ACTION IMPLEMENTED · PHYSICAL COMPLIANCE · MONITORING VERIFIED

CORE CLAIM
- CLEARANCE GRANTED → legal decision
- CONDITION LISTED → required safeguard

MECHANISM
- ACTION IMPLEMENTED → physical compliance
- MONITORING VERIFIED → evidence stage

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- OUTCOME → environmental result, separately assessed
- CLEARANCE GRANTED → legal decision

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MONITORING VERIFIED → evidence stage; OUTCOME → environmental result, separately assessed.

08

STAGE 08

NGT IDENTITY MAP

NGT IDENTITY MAP · SPECIALISED STATUTORY TRIBUNAL · CPCB OR SPCB · POLLUTION-CONTROL REGULATOR · EAC OR SEAC · APPRAISAL COMMITTEE · CLEARANCE AUTHORITY · ADMINISTRATIVE DECISION-MAKER

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
NGT → specialised statutory tribunal	EAC OR SEAC → appraisal committee	CONSTITUTIONAL COURT → writ and appellate constitutional role
CPCB OR SPCB → pollution-control regulator	CLEARANCE AUTHORITY → administrative decision-maker	NGT → specialised statutory tribunal

CORE CLAIM
- NGT → specialised statutory tribunal
- CPCB OR SPCB → pollution-control regulator

MECHANISM
- EAC OR SEAC → appraisal committee
- CLEARANCE AUTHORITY → administrative decision-maker

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CONSTITUTIONAL COURT → writ and appellate constitutional role
- NGT → specialised statutory tribunal

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONSTITUTIONAL COURT → writ and appellate constitutional role.

09

STAGE 09

JURISDICTION FORK

JURISDICTION FORK · SUBSTANTIAL ENVIRONMENTAL QUESTION · TEST SCHEDULE I BOUNDARY · ORIGINAL CASE · CIVIL ENVIRONMENTAL DISPUTE UNDER THE ACT · SPECIFIED ORDER AND APPEAL PROVISION · WRIT ROUTE · SEPARATE CONSTITUTIONAL REVIEW

SUBSTANTIAL ENVIRONMENTAL QUESTION → test Schedule I boundary

ORIGINAL CASE → civil environmental dispute under the Act → APPEAL → specified order and appeal provision → WRIT ROUTE → separate constitutional review

CORE CLAIM
- SUBSTANTIAL ENVIRONMENTAL QUESTION → test Schedule I boundary
- ORIGINAL CASE → civil environmental dispute under the Act

MECHANISM
- APPEAL → specified order and appeal provision
- WRIT ROUTE → separate constitutional review

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- NO LABEL-BASED JURISDICTION → statute controls
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: EIA notification is not an Act, Terms of Reference are not clearance,...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: EIA notification is not an Act, Terms of Reference are not clearance,..

10

STAGE 10

REMEDY AND LIMITATION MATRIX

REMEDY AND LIMITATION MATRIX · RELIEF OR COMPENSATION · PERSON OR DAMAGE CLAIM · PROPERTY RESTITUTION · RESTORE AFFECTED PROPERTY · ENVIRONMENT RESTITUTION · REPAIR ENVIRONMENTAL HARM · REMEDY-SPECIFIC CLOCK AND EXTENSION

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
RELIEF OR COMPENSATION → person or damage claim	ENVIRONMENT RESTITUTION → repair environmental harm	PRINCIPLES → apply within jurisdiction and evidence
PROPERTY RESTITUTION → restore affected property	LIMITATION → remedy-specific clock and extension	EVIDENCE LIMIT: MECHANISM / STATUS / CAUSATION: State project category, competent...

CORE CLAIM
- RELIEF OR COMPENSATION → person or damage claim
- PROPERTY RESTITUTION → restore affected property

MECHANISM
- ENVIRONMENT RESTITUTION → repair environmental harm
- LIMITATION → remedy-specific clock and extension

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- PRINCIPLES → apply within jurisdiction and evidence
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: MECHANISM / STATUS / CAUSATION: State project category, competent...

MECHANISM / VERDICT — EVIDENCE LIMIT: MECHANISM / STATUS / CAUSATION: State project category, competent...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: MECHANISM / STATUS / CAUSATION: State project category, competent.

11

STAGE 11

INSTRUMENT AND ANSWER SPINE

INSTRUMENT AND ANSWER SPINE · APPLICABILITY, CATEGORY, STUDY AND CONSULTATION · APPRAISAL, REASONED ORDER AND DISTINCT APPROVALS · CONDITIONS, COMPLIANCE AND ENVIRONMENTAL OUTCOME · NGT JURISDICTION, APPEAL, RELIEF AND LIMITATION · DRAFT, NOTIFICATION, MEMORANDUM, JUDGMENT AND PYQ STATUS

PREVENT → applicability, category, study and consultation → DECIDE → appraisal, reasoned order and distinct approvals → MONITOR → conditions, compliance and environmental outcome → REMEDY → NGT jurisdiction, appeal, relief and limitation → AUDIT → draft, notification, memorandum, judgment and PYQ status

CORE CLAIM
- PREVENT → applicability, category, study and consultation
- DECIDE → appraisal, reasoned order and distinct approvals

MECHANISM
- MONITOR → conditions, compliance and environmental outcome
- REMEDY → NGT jurisdiction, appeal, relief and limitation

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- AUDIT → draft, notification, memorandum, judgment and PYQ status
- PREVENT → applicability, category, study and consultation

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: AUDIT → draft, notification, memorandum, judgment and PYQ status.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · PERIODIC PROPOSALS TO STREAMLINE OR REVISE THE EIA PROCESS · BALANCED FRAMING FOR MAINS · PRESENT THIS AS A GENUINE TRADE-OFF REQUIRING CAREFUL · COMPREHENSIVE, INDEPENDENTLY COMPILED NATIONAL DATA ON EIA CLEARANCE APPROVAL/ · NGT CASE-DISPOSAL STATISTICS (PENDENCY, AVERAGE DISPOSAL TIME) ARE REPORTED · POST-FACTO (RETROSPECTIVE) ENVIRONMENTAL CLEARANCE HAS BEEN TREATED BY INDIAN · NGT'S ORIGINAL JURISDICTION COVERS SUBSTANTIAL QUESTIONS RELATING TO ENVIRONMENT

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- CAUTION: Periodic proposals to streamline or revise the EIA process (e.g., reducing timelines,
- CAUTION: Balanced framing for Mains: present this as a genuine trade-off requiring careful
- CAUTION: Comprehensive, independently compiled national data on EIA clearance approval/
- CAUTION: NGT case-disposal statistics (pendency, average disposal time) are reported

ADVANCED DEBATE
- Post-facto (retrospective) environmental clearance has been treated by Indian courts and
- NGT's original jurisdiction covers substantial questions relating to environment arising
- Public consultation under the EIA process has faced documented implementation critiques
- NGT order implementation ultimately depends on executive/state-agency compliance

LEGACY / NUANCE
- NOT: Post-facto environmental clearance has been judicially endorsed as a routine, regular
- NOT: NGT has unlimited jurisdiction over every environment-related legal matter in India.
- NOT: Public-consultation critiques primarily concern the absence of any consultation
- NOT: NGT orders are self-executing and require no further executive action. - Implementation

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels